

Windows 10 Installation Guide

Preparation

Step 1 — Check System Requirements

Windows 10 requires the following minimum specifications:

Processor	1 GHz or faster, 64-bit
RAM	2 GB minimum (4 GB+ recommended)
Storage	20 GB minimum (64 GB+ recommended)
Firmware	UEFI with Secure Boot support

Check if your laptop supports UEFI

1. Press Win + R, type msinfo32, and hit Enter
2. In System Information, look for **BIOS Mode** — it should say *UEFI*

Processor	Intel(R) Core(TM) i3-1005G1 CPU @ 1.20GHz, 1190 Mhz, 2 Core(s), 4 Logica...
BIOS Version/Date	Insyde F.57, 9/19/2022
SMBIOS Version	3.2
Embedded Controller Version	40.38
BIOS Mode	UEFI
BaseBoard Manufacturer	HP
BaseBoard Product	85F3
BaseBoard Version	40.38
Platform Role	Mobile

Step 2 — Back Up Your Data

Back up the following before continuing:

- Personal files: documents, photos, videos to an external drive or cloud storage
- Browser bookmarks (export from your browser's settings menu)
- A list of installed software and product keys (use Belarc Advisor to find keys)
- Email signatures, saved passwords, and custom app configurations

Step 3 — Create a Bootable USB Drive

- Create bootable pendrive using Media Creation Tool from Microsoft
- Or download the Win 10 ISO from the Microsoft website and use Rufus software to write it. Select GPT partition scheme for UEFI.

Step 4 — Enter BIOS and Configure Settings

Restart your laptop and press the BIOS key during startup. Common keys by manufacturer: F2, F10/Del

In BIOS, configure the following:

- Enable UEFI boot mode (disable Legacy / CSM if present)
- Enable Secure Boot
- Set the USB drive as the first boot device in the boot order
- Save and exit

Step 5 — Boot from USB

With the USB inserted and BIOS configured, restart the laptop. The Windows setup screen should appear. If not, press the boot menu key (F12, F9, or Esc depending on your brand) and manually select the USB drive from the list.

Step 6 — Begin Setup

- Click Install Now on the setup screen
- Enter your product key, or click I don't have a product key to skip (activate later)
- Select your edition: Windows 10 Home for personal use, Pro for advanced features
- Accept the license agreement
- Choose Custom: Install Windows only for a clean install

Step 7 — Partition Your Drive

This is the most critical step. You will see a list of drives and partitions.

Fresh install (entire drive):

- Delete all existing partitions on the target drive
- Click New — Windows will automatically create the required system partitions
- Select the largest (primary) partition and click Next

Dual boot (keeping an existing OS):

- Do not delete the existing OS partition
- Shrink the existing partition first using Disk Management inside your current OS
- Select the resulting unallocated space and click Next

Step 8 — Wait for Installation to Complete

Windows will copy files, install features, and apply updates. This takes 10–30 minutes depending on hardware speed. The laptop will restart several times. Leave the USB plugged in but do not press any key when prompted to boot from USB.

Phase 4: Initial Setup (OOBE)

Step 9 — Region, Account & Preferences

- Select your region and keyboard layout
- Connect to Wi-Fi when prompted
- Create a username and password for your account
- Set security questions for local account recovery

Step 10 — Privacy During Setup

Windows presents a privacy screen during setup.

Step 11 — Run Windows Update

- Go to Settings → Update & Security → Windows Update
- Click Check for updates and install all pending updates
- Restart when prompted — repeat until no updates remain (may take 2–3 cycles)

Step 12 — Install Drivers

Windows Update handles most drivers automatically. The drivers latest version can be verified from the manufacturers website.

Step 13 — Final Recommended Settings

- Activate Windows: Settings → Update & Security → Activation
- Set a power plan: Control Panel → Power Options → Balanced or High Performance
- Create a restore point: Search Create a restore point → Configure → Create
- Enable Windows Defender: Settings → Windows Security and confirm it is active
- Install essentials: browser, antivirus, productivity and communication apps